

NICHOLLS STATE UNIVERSITY - Request for HSIRB Exemption

Filled draft for: HR Situational Judgment Test: Evidence-Based HR Decision-Making

Form: HSIRB-exempt_review_request.rev9_2019.v2

Status: Ready for PI signature / college rep recommendation

Attachments: CITI certificate (`docs/citiCompletionCertificate\_4689946\_59381539.pdf`); instrument (`incidents.json` / IRB packet); consent forms (professional + class)

1. Investigators

| Field | Response |

| Name(s) of Principal Investigator(s) | Dr. Christopher Castille |

| Phone | 985-449-7015 |

| Other Investigators | None |

| Faculty Sponsor (If Student Research) | N/A (faculty PI) |

| Faculty Sponsor Phone | N/A |

2. Unit

| Field | Response |

| College | Al Danos College of Business Administration |

| Department | Management and Marketing |

| Phone | 985-449-7015 |

3. Title of Project or Proposal

HR Situational Judgment Test: Evidence-Based HR Decision-Making

4. Description of Project or Proposal

4a. Population of human subjects

Two groups, all 18 years of age or older:

1. Undergraduate students enrolled in MNGT 425 (HR Analytics) and related Management and Marketing courses at Nicholls State University. Research use of their course/assignment ratings (secondary data consent) is VOLUNTARY and has no effect on course grade ("grade shield").

2. HR professionals / working professionals recruited through professional networks. Participation is VOLUNTARY.

Subjects under 18 are excluded (required for HSIRB exemption).

4b. Research procedures and data collection

1. Electronic informed consent (separate forms for professionals and for class/students).

2. Participant ID generated from name for the live assessment; names are not stored with research data. Professionals may complete brief optional demographics.

3. Online HR Situational Judgment Test: 27 HR management scenarios; participants may rate tactic effectiveness on a 1–5 scale. Ratings are optional; each situation may be skipped (no forced responding).

4. Feedback PDF / debriefing materials.

Instrument / active links for IRB:

| Material | Link or path |

| Interactive survey review (all 27 situations; skip/optional ratings; no API) |
<https://bayoupal.nicholls.edu/hsirb/studies/hr-sjt/run/> |

| Professional consent (live) | <https://bayoupal.nicholls.edu/hsirb/studies/hr-sjt/professional-consent/> |

| Class/student consent (live) | <https://bayoupal.nicholls.edu/hsirb/studies/hr-sjt/student-data-consent/> |

| Professional consent (static HTML) | ``docs/HR_SJT_PROFESSIONAL_CONSENT.html`` |

| Class/student consent (static HTML) | ``docs/HR_SJT_STUDENT_CONSENT.html`` |

| Full incident text | ``apps/studies/assets/irb/hr-sjt/incidents.json`` |

| Live assessment host | <https://bayoupal.nicholls.edu/hr-sjt-assessment/> |

Printed / electronic copies of the instrument are provided via the interactive IRB packet and ``incidents.json``.

4c. Objectives of the research

1. Measure how students evaluate HR management tactics in situational judgment scenarios.
2. Measure how HR professionals evaluate the same tactics (expert benchmark).
3. Compare student vs. professional ratings to identify gaps and educational opportunities.
4. Identify which tactics are rated most/least effective across HR domains.
5. Examine whether evidence-based HR training shifts student ratings toward professional norms (if pre/post design is used).

5. Recruitment

5a. How will you recruit subjects? (verbatim materials)

Students: Course announcement / PRAMS listing for MNGT 425 and related courses; secondary-data consent page for research use of existing ratings.

Recruitment script (students / PRAMS):

- > Study Title: HR Situational Judgment Test: Evidence-Based HR Decision-Making
- > Description: You will complete an online HR Situational Judgment Test with 27 HR management scenarios. For each scenario, you will rate the effectiveness of different HR tactics. You will receive a feedback report. Your responses will be used for research on HR education and decision-making.
- > Duration: Approximately 45–60 minutes
- > Mode: Online (complete at your own pace)
- > Requirements: Must be 18 years of age or older

HR professionals: Outreach via professional networks (e.g., LinkedIn, SHRM chapters, HR associations) using the same study description and the professional consent page.

5b. Inclusion criteria

- Age 18 or older
- Students: currently enrolled in MNGT 425 or related Management and Marketing courses at Nicholls
- Professionals: current or recent professional HR experience
- Access to a computer/device with internet

5c. Exclusion criteria

- Under 18
- Unable to complete online assessments
- Prior participation in this study (duplicate responses)
- Students not enrolled at Nicholls (for student arm)
- Professionals with no current/recent HR experience (for professional arm)

6. Subject benefits and costs

6a. Benefits

1. Human subjects: Feedback reports; learning about evidence-based HR / SJT; contribution to research; optional aggregated infographic (no individuals identified).
2. Others with similar problems / roles: Educators and HR trainers may use findings to improve HR education.
3. Society: Better understanding of HR situational judgment and evidence-based HR education.

6b. Payment

No monetary compensation. MNGT 425 exercise supplements class time; research secondary-data consent is voluntary with no grade impact. All participants may receive feedback reports / optional infographic signup.

6c. Estimated costs to each subject

1. Time: Approximately 45–60 minutes for the live assessment arm; class secondary-data consent requires only reading/signing the consent (no new tasks).
2. Money: None.
3. Repeated testing: Not required (optional pre/post training comparison only if that design is used later under the same protocol).

7. Basis of request for exemption

■ D. Limited to collection/study of data obtained using the techniques below AND recorded so subjects cannot be identified, directly or indirectly, through identifiers linked with the subjects.

Applicable techniques under D:

- ■ D-1. Educational tests (cognitive, diagnostic, aptitude, achievement, etc.) — situational judgment assessment
- ■ D-3. Survey or interview procedures — online rating interface / consent questionnaire

Also consistent with educational setting practices (Category A elements) for the classroom-linked student arm, but primary requested basis is Category D.

■ A, ■ B, ■ C, ■ E — not the primary claimed basis.

8. CITI training

Attach current CITI certificate(s) for all investigators.

- PI: Dr. Christopher Castille — Human Subjects Research (Social/Behavioral Research)
- Completion: 2024-05-10
- Expiration: 2026-05-10
- Record ID: 59381539

- File: `docs/citiCompletionCertificate\_4689946\_59381539.pdf`

9. Statement of risk

The undersigned certify that they believe that the conduct of the above described research creates no risk of physical or emotional harm, or social or legal embarrassment to any participating human subject.

Signature of Principal Investigator: _____ Date: _____

10. Faculty sponsor

N/A — Principal investigator is a faculty member.

11. Recommendation of HSIRB representative or HSIRB chair

I recommend that the above described research project be exempt from review.

Signature of Chairperson / Representative: _____ Date: _____

HSIRB PROTOCOL NUMBER: _____

Appendix checklist (submit with this form)

- [x] Filled exemption request (this document / PDF)
- [x] CITI certificate (PI)
- [x] Professional consent form
- [x] Class/student consent form
- [x] Data collection instrument (27 situations — interactive packet + `incidents.json`)
- [x] Recruitment script (verbatim, Section 5a)
- [x] Protocol narrative (`HR\_SJT\_PROTOCOL\_PRAMS.md` / `protocol.json`)

Suggested college representative / reviewers: Jon Murphy (CBA), Juliann Allen